

Traditional culture

Older people can pass culture on to the next generation, enabling a society's traditions to be preserved for many years. The *Ramayana*, a Hindu poem written in the 5th or 4th century BCE, tells the story of Rama and Sita, and their battle against the demon-king Ravana. Over many generations, the *Ramayana* and its values have been kept alive in India and southern Asia through writing, story telling, painting, sculpture, festivals, music, and dance.



Literature

The *Ramayana* was originally written in Sanskrit, the language of Hinduism and ancient Indian literary texts.



Sculpture

The great warrior Rama, holding his bow, stands next to his wife Sita. Both hold up their right hands in blessing.

Festival

At the Hindu festival of Diwali, people light lamps to commemorate Rama's return from exile and his victory over Ravana.



Painting

In this scene from the *Ramakien*, a Thai version of the *Ramayana*, the monkey god Hanuman uses his body as a bridge for Rama to cross.



Music

Musicians in Bali, Indonesia, provide accompaniment to kecak dancers, who perform parts of the *Ramayana*.

